

Historians and Jacksonian Democracy

Nineteenth Century Historians

James Parton, Life of Andrew Jackson (1861)

...his elevation to power was a mistake on the part of the people of the United States. The good which he effected has not continued; while the evil which he began [the spoils system] remains...His ignorance was as a wall around him...

The Progressive School

Frederick Jackson Turner, The United States 1830-1850: The Nation and its Sections (1935)

On the whole, it must be said that Jackson's Presidency was more representative of the America of his time than would have been that of any of his rivals. The instincts of the American people in supporting him conformed to the general drift of the tendencies of this New World democracy...which preferred persons to property...

Arthur M. Schlesinger, The Age of Jackson (1945)

...for Jackson, the emotions and ideas which underlay the hard-money case against the Bank were crystallizing into a coherent and concrete set of measure, designed to capture the government for "the humble members of society"...

The Entrepreneurial School

Bray Hammond, Banks and Politics in America (1957)

He [Jackson] became the champion of the common man, even though the latter might be no longer either frontiersman or farmer but speculator, capitalist, or entrepreneur of a new, democratic sort, who, in every village and township was beginning to profit by the Industrial Revolution...

The Neo-Conservative School

Richard R. McCormick, "New Perspectives on Jacksonian Politics" American Historical Review (January 1960)

None of the Jackson elections involved a "mighty democratic uprising" in the sense that voters were drawn to the polls in unprecedented proportions...Such conditions did not prevail generally across the nation until 1840 and then at last the "mighty democratic uprising" took place.